

VFM® Value Flow Mechanisms Architecture — Value Lifecycle Governance Layer

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Official Value Lifecycle Governance Architecture for AI Systems, Autonomous Systems, Organizations, Assets, Infrastructure, Data, Technology, Economic Systems, Public Systems, Digital Environments, and Future Value-Based Systems

VFM® serves as the official OOF® value lifecycle governance architecture used for value context governance, value origin governance, value emergence governance, value recognition governance, value state governance, value change governance, value development governance, value degradation governance, value nullification governance, value restoration governance, and value extinction governance across AI systems, autonomous systems, organizations, industrial systems, physical and digital assets, infrastructure, data, technology, intellectual property, public systems, economic environments, and future value-based systems.

Value Flow Mechanisms Architecture (VFM®) does not define what value must be for every domain. VFM® defines the governance architecture required to determine how value exists within a context, where it originates, how it emerges, how it becomes recognized, which state it occupies, how it changes, how it develops or degrades, when it reaches zero, whether previously existing value can be restored, and when its recoverability legitimately ends.

VFM® consists of 11 Core Parent Standards and 55 Core Modules forming the primary value lifecycle governance backbone within the OOF® ecosystem.

Additional compatible standards, bridge standards, domain-specific value models, assessment methodologies, and specialized value governance standards may extend the architecture when new value governance spaces are identified. However, the standards listed below form the official core value lifecycle governance structure of VFM®.

Canonical Definition

Value Flow Mechanisms Architecture (VFM®) is the value lifecycle governance architecture that defines the structural and methodological conditions under which value is contextualized, originated, emerged, recognized, placed into a governed state, changed, developed, degraded, nullified, restored, or ultimately extinguished throughout its governed lifecycle.

VFM® treats value not merely as a price, financial quantity, accounting measure, utility score, or subjective judgment, but as a governable lifecycle phenomenon whose existence, state, transformation, recoverability, and finality can be methodologically distinguished.

The architecture therefore enables different systems to reason about value without requiring every system to use the same economic, technological, social, operational, or institutional definition of value.

Core Question

How can value remain methodologically governable from the context in which it becomes meaningful through its origin, emergence, recognition, state, transformation, development, degradation, nullification, restoration, and eventual extinction?

Governance Flow

Value Context → Value Origin → Value Emergence → Value Recognition → Value State → Value Change → Value Development / Value Degradation → Value Nullification → Value Restoration / Value Extinction

The lifecycle is intentionally non-linear.

Value may develop, degrade, change repeatedly, reach zero, remain dormant, become inaccessible, recover through restoration, enter a new governed state, or ultimately cross the boundary into extinction.

Core Parent Standards

1. Value Context Standard

Governed Space: Value Context

Core Question: Within which context does the relevant value exist, for whom or for what does it become meaningful, and which contextual boundaries govern its interpretation?

2. Value Origin Standard

Governed Space: Value Origin

Core Question: From where does the relevant value originate, and what establishes its legitimate value-origin basis?

3. Value Emergence Standard

Governed Space: Value Emergence

Core Question: How and under which conditions does value that did not previously exist become present within the governed lifecycle?

4. Value Recognition Standard

Governed Space: Value Recognition

Core Question: When and under which conditions may existing or emerging value become legitimately recognized as value within the governed context?

5. Value State Standard (VSS)

Governed Space: Value State

Core Question: What is the current governed state of the relevant value, and how must that state be distinguished from the events and mechanisms that produced it?

6. Value Change Standard (VCS)

Governed Space: Value Change

Core Question: What has changed in the relevant value, independently of the external event, cause, actor, or system that produced the change?

7. Value Development Standard (VDS)

Governed Space: Value Development

Core Question: How does already existing value legitimately grow, mature, compound, strengthen, or otherwise develop within its governed lifecycle?

8. Value Degradation Standard (VDGS)

Governed Space: Value Degradation

Core Question: How does existing value decline, weaken, deteriorate, become impaired, or progressively lose value while value still remains?

9. Value Nullification Standard (VNS)

Governed Space: Value Nullification

Core Question: When and through which governed conditions or mechanisms does previously existing value reach zero?

10. Value Restoration Standard (VRSS)

Governed Space: Value Restoration

Core Question: How can degraded, lost, dormant, inaccessible, impaired, or zero value legitimately re-emerge or be restored?

11. Value Extinction Standard (VXSS)

Governed Space: Value Extinction

Core Question: When does value cease to exist as recoverable value within the governed lifecycle?

Compatible OOF® Architectures

VFM® interoperates with multiple OOF® architectures governing complementary spaces surrounding value.

GOA™ — Governance Architecture provides the constitutional governance layer through which authority, boundaries, scope, delegation, continuity, and interoperability surrounding value governance can be structured.

ORA™ — Operational Reality Architecture governs what is actually occurring in Operational Reality, while VFM® governs what those realities mean for the lifecycle condition of relevant value.

VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture governs whether claims, evidence, methodologies, and determinations are sufficiently validated for intended reliance, while VFM® governs the lifecycle of the value to which validated information may relate.

INTEGROS® — Integrity Governance Architecture governs integrity across objects, systems, states, evidence, and processes, while VFM® governs how value associated with those objects or systems exists and changes.

ADIT® governs evidential observation, preservation, verification, and auditability, while VFM® governs the value lifecycle consequences that governed evidence may help establish.

AGA™ — Accountability Governance Architecture governs responsibility, authority, attribution, and accountability for decisions and actions that may create, develop, degrade, nullify, restore, or destroy value.

CLA® — Classification Architecture governs classification, while VFM® governs value. Classification of an object or value condition does not itself establish the lifecycle state of its value.

OBIDENITY® — Identity Governance Architecture governs origin-bound identity, ownership, authority, provenance, transfer, and continuity, while VFM® governs the lifecycle of value associated with identified objects, relationships, capabilities, or systems.

AIG® — AI Governance Architecture governs behavioral governance of AI systems, while VFM® may govern the value created, consumed, transformed, degraded, restored, or lost through AI activity.

ASGA™ — Autonomous Systems Governance Architecture governs autonomous authority, constraints, actions, coordination, and operational behavior, while VFM® may govern the value consequences of autonomous activity.

SIMULOS® — Simulation Governance Architecture may simulate future value conditions, transitions, degradation, restoration, or extinction, while VFM® provides the value lifecycle structures whose behavior may be represented within those simulations.

VFM® therefore operates as a horizontal value lifecycle architecture capable of interacting with governance architectures concerned with reality, identity, classification, validation, evidence, integrity, accountability, intelligence, autonomy, and simulation without assuming ownership of those governance spaces.

Architectural Position

VFM® governs the complete lifecycle of value as a governable phenomenon.

The architecture progresses through:

Value Context → Value Origin → Value Emergence → Value Recognition → Value State → Value Change → Value Development / Value Degradation → Value Nullification → Value Restoration / Value Extinction

Together these spaces establish where value becomes meaningful, where it comes from, how it appears, how it becomes recognized, what condition it occupies, how that condition changes, how value grows or declines, how it may reach zero, whether previously existing value can return, and when the lifecycle of that same value legitimately ends.

VFM® is not restricted to a single concept of economic value.

Its architecture can govern value relationships involving:

Economic Value · Operational Value · Functional Value · Informational Value · Technological Value · Strategic Value · Productive Value · Infrastructural Value · Organizational Value · Digital Value · Knowledge Value · Capability Value · Relational Value · Context-Specific Value

The governing structure remains stable even when the meaning of value differs between domains.

Core Governed Value Spaces

VFM® establishes eleven distinct governable value spaces.

Value Context → establishes where, for whom, for what purpose, and under which conditions value becomes meaningful.

Value Origin → establishes the origin basis from which relevant value derives.

Value Emergence → governs the appearance of value that did not previously exist within the relevant lifecycle.

Value Recognition → governs when existing or emerging value becomes legitimately recognized.

Value State → establishes the current governed condition of value.

Value Change → establishes what happened to value when its condition changed.

Value Development → governs growth, maturation, strengthening, and compounding of existing value.

Value Degradation → governs decline, impairment, deterioration, weakening, and progressive loss of existing value.

Value Nullification → governs the transition through which previously existing value reaches zero.

Value Restoration → governs the recovery of previously existing degraded, lost, dormant, inaccessible, impaired, or zero value.

Value Extinction → governs the terminal boundary beyond which the same value no longer remains legitimately recoverable within its governed lifecycle.

Each space answers a different methodological question.

Each may change independently.

Each may require different evidence.

Each may interact with different external systems.

Their separation is therefore foundational to VFM®.

Core Value Mechanisms and States

VFM® introduces explicit separation between value states and value transition mechanisms.

Value Asset™

Value Asset™ represents an object, capability, relationship, resource, system, information structure, or other governed object carrying recognized positive value within a defined value context.

ZVA™ — Zero Value Asset™

ZVA™ represents a governed condition in which relevant value has reached zero while the underlying object, relationship, capability, information, or other value-bearing structure may continue to exist.

Zero Value ≠ Non-Existence.

Zero Value ≠ Value Extinction.

DeMonet™

DeMonet™ represents a governed value-nullification mechanism through which previously existing value transitions toward or reaches zero.

Canonical transition:

Positive Value → DeMonet™ → Zero-Value Condition → ZVA™

ReMonet™

ReMonet™ represents a governed value-restoration mechanism through which previously existing degraded, impaired, dormant, lost, inaccessible, or zero value may become recoverable and re-enter a positive governed value state.

Canonical transition:

Degraded / Dormant / Zero Value → ReMonet™ → Restored Value → New Value State

These distinctions allow VFM® to model value transitions without confusing the state of value with the mechanism producing that state.

Cross-Architecture Boundary Lock

VFM® is intentionally bounded to prevent value governance from absorbing adjacent governance domains.

VFM® ↔ ORA™

ORA™: What is actually occurring in Operational Reality?

VFM®: What has happened to relevant value within that reality?

Operational Change ≠ Value Change.

VFM® ↔ OBIDENTITY®

OBIDENTITY®: What is the object, where did it originate, who owns it, and under what authority and provenance does it exist?

VFM®: What value exists in relation to that object and how does that value evolve?

Object Identity ≠ Value Identity.

Object Origin ≠ Value Origin.

VFM® ↔ CLA®

CLA®: governs how objects, states, evidence, or other governed entities are classified.

VFM®: governs the lifecycle condition of value.

Classification ≠ Value Recognition.

VFM® ↔ VALIDOS®

VALIDOS®: governs whether a claim or determination has sufficient validation basis.

VFM®: governs the value lifecycle condition that may be the subject of such a determination.

Validated Claim About Value ≠ Value Itself.

VFM® ↔ ADIT®

ADIT®: governs evidence and auditability.

VFM®: governs value lifecycle states and transitions.

Evidence of Value Change ≠ Value Change Itself.

VFM® ↔ INTEGROS®

INTEGROS®: governs integrity.

VFM®: governs value.

An object may retain structural integrity while losing value, or lose integrity while retaining another form of value.

Integrity State ≠ Value State.

VFM® ↔ AGA™

AGA™: governs who is accountable for value-related decisions and consequences.

VFM®: governs what occurred to value.

Value Consequence $\neq$ Accountability Determination.

VFM® $\leftrightarrow$ SIMULOS®

SIMULOS®: governs simulation of possible conditions and outcomes.

VFM®: governs value lifecycle structures that may exist in actual or simulated environments.

Simulated Value Outcome $\neq$ Actual Value State.

Universal Application Principle

Value is not confined to financial systems.

A machine has productive value.

A dataset has informational value.

An algorithm has functional value.

An infrastructure network has operational and societal value.

A patent may have technological, strategic, licensing, or economic value.

An organization has capabilities whose value may develop or degrade.

An AI system consumes resources while creating, transforming, preserving, or destroying value.

A public institution allocates resources against expected public value.

A tax system identifies, measures, attributes, transforms, and transfers economic value under legal authority.

A digital asset may retain technical existence while its economic value reaches zero.

Historical information may have no present commercial value while retaining scientific or cultural value.

Value may therefore be present even where no monetary price exists.

This makes VFM® inherently cross-domain.

AI and Autonomous Systems Application

Future AI systems will increasingly require more than optimization toward a single reward or utility function.

A sufficiently advanced system may need to distinguish:

what has value;

within which context it has value;

where that value originated;

whether the value already existed or newly emerged;

whether value merely changed or was actually created;

whether apparent value growth is genuine development;

whether an action degraded another value dimension;

whether value reached zero;

whether lost value remains recoverable;

whether restoration represents recovery or creation of new value;

and whether a prior value lifecycle has legitimately ended.

VFM® can provide a governance layer through which AI systems reason about those distinctions without reducing every decision to a single monetary or optimization variable.

Combined with AIG®, ASGA™, GOA™, ORA™, VALIDOS®, AGA™, INTEGROS®, ADIT®, CLIA®, MGIA™, SIMULOS®, and OBIDENTITY®, VFM® can contribute to future systems capable of reasoning not merely about what action is possible, but about what value exists, what value may be affected, and what value consequences an action may produce.

Future Economic and Tax System Application

VFM® can also provide a methodological layer for future economic, accounting, fiscal, or taxation architectures.

Traditional taxation frequently begins after an economically relevant event has already been legally classified.

A future value-aware system could instead distinguish:

Value Origin → Value Emergence → Value Recognition → Value State → Value Change → Value Development → Value Degradation → Value Nullification → Value Restoration → Value Extinction

This does not mean VFM® determines taxation.

Tax Governance ≠ Value Lifecycle Governance.

Rather, VFM® can provide a standardized value lifecycle layer upon which specialized tax governance can determine which value events are legally relevant, attributable, measurable, taxable, exempt, deferred, restored, transferred, or extinguished.

Combined with identity, provenance, accountability, operational reality, validation, evidence, and classification architectures, this could support future systems in which taxation responds more precisely to the actual governed lifecycle of economic value.

Enterprise and Industrial Application

VFM® can be applied to:

industrial machinery and productive assets;

critical infrastructure;

data and information assets;

software and digital platforms;

intellectual property;

organizational capabilities;

technology portfolios;

research and development;

AI investments;

supply chains;

energy systems;

public infrastructure;

investment portfolios;

stranded assets;

legacy systems;

and long-lived strategic resources.

Instead of asking only:

“What is this worth today?”

VFM® enables a broader governance sequence:

Where does its value exist?

Where did that value originate?

How did it emerge?

Has it been legitimately recognized?

What state is it currently in?

What changed?

Is it developing or degrading?

Has value reached zero?

Can previously existing value be restored?

Or has that value lifecycle legitimately ended?

Multi-Dimensional Value Principle

The same object may simultaneously carry multiple forms of value.

A discontinued industrial machine may have:

zero productive value;

positive material value;

positive spare-parts value;

historical value;

negative storage value;

potential future restoration value.

Therefore:

Value Extinction in One Dimension $\neq$ Value Extinction in Every Dimension.

Similarly:

Zero Economic Value $\neq$ Zero Functional Value.

Zero Operational Value $\neq$ Zero Informational Value.

Loss of Current Value $\neq$ Loss of Future Value Potential.

VFM® governs these distinctions through explicit context, state, lifecycle, and recoverability boundaries.

Recursive Value Lifecycle Principle

VFM® does not assume that value moves only forward.

A governed lifecycle may include:

Positive Value → Degradation → Zero Value → Restoration → Positive Value

or:

Positive Value → Development → Change → Degradation → Restoration → New Value State

or:

Positive Value → Nullification → ZVA™ → ReMonet™ → Restored Value

or ultimately:

Recoverable Value → Loss of Recoverability → Value Extinction → Value Finality

This produces a recursive lifecycle:

Value State → Value Change → New Value State → Further Change → Restoration / Development / Degradation / Nullification → New Value State

until the recoverability boundary is legitimately crossed.

Value Extinction closes the lifecycle of the same governed value.

If genuinely new value later appears after legitimate extinction, that value may enter through Value Emergence as a new lifecycle rather than being falsely represented as restoration of the extinct value.

Architectural Structure

Architecture: VFM® — Value Flow Mechanisms Architecture Category: Governance & Enforcement Subcategory: Value Lifecycle Governance Core Parent Standards: 11 Core Modules: 55 Architecture Model: Lifecycle-Based · Modular · Recursive · Cross-Domain Primary Governance Domain: Value Lifecycle Governance

The architecture deliberately separates governable spaces that can independently change or fail.

A system may:

identify the wrong value context;

confuse object origin with value origin;

fail to distinguish emerging value from existing value;

recognize value without sufficient basis;

misidentify the current value state;

confuse an external event with the resulting value change;

confuse value creation with value development;

treat degradation as nullification;

treat zero value as extinction;

treat new value as restored value;

or declare extinction while legitimate recoverability still exists.

VFM® treats these not as one generic value management problem, but as distinct value lifecycle governance spaces requiring distinct methodological boundaries.

Foundational Architecture Principles

Value exists within context.

Value Context ≠ Value State.

Object Origin ≠ Value Origin.

Value Emergence ≠ Value Recognition.

Value Recognition ≠ Classification.

Value Recognition ≠ Validation.

Value State ≠ Value Transition.

Operational Change ≠ Value Change.

Value Emergence ≠ Development of Existing Value.

Creation of Value ≠ Growth of Value.

Value Development ≠ Value Restoration.

Value Degradation ≠ Value Nullification.

Zero Value ≠ Value Extinction.

ZVA™ ≠ Non-Existence.

DeMonet™ is a transition mechanism, not a value state.

ReMonet™ is a restoration mechanism, not proof that restoration succeeded.

Failed Restoration ≠ Value Extinction.

Dormancy ≠ Value Extinction.

Inaccessibility ≠ Value Extinction.

Object Destruction ≠ Automatic Extinction of Every Value Dimension.

Value Extinction ≠ Object Extinction.

Contextual Extinction ≠ Universal Extinction.

Replacement Value ≠ Restored Value.

Newly Emerged Value ≠ Restored Extinguished Value.

Value Finality ≠ Erasure of Value History.

The same object may simultaneously carry different value states across different value dimensions and contexts.

Canonical Principle

VFM® does not determine ownership, identity, legality, taxation, classification, validation, integrity, accountability, evidential sufficiency, operational reality, or economic policy. VFM® governs the lifecycle of value itself by establishing the methodological conditions through which value is contextualized, originated, emerged, recognized, placed into governed states, changed, developed, degraded, nullified, restored, or determined to have crossed the boundary into extinction.

VFM® provides a common value lifecycle architecture capable of operating across physical, digital, economic, technological, informational, organizational, public, autonomous, and future intelligent systems without requiring value to be reduced to price alone.

Wherever value can exist, change, disappear, recover, or become terminal, a value lifecycle exists that can be governed.

Related Documents

[→ VFM® Architecture Map](#)

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